

TRAI INC.

The 10-Point Cloud & Architecture Audit

Stop burning money on bad architecture. Use this executive checklist to evaluate your startup's technical foundation.

How to use this document

Founders are often overpaying for cloud servers or dealing with brittle architecture left behind by cheap freelancers. If you check "No" on more than 3 of these items, your tech stack is actively bleeding money or creating massive security risks.

1

☐ YES ☐ NO

Database Indexing

Are your most heavily queried database columns properly indexed? Missing indexes are the #1 cause of high Cloud SQL bills and sluggish performance. A simple EXPLAIN ANALYZE on your top queries can save 80% on database costs.

2

☐ YES ☐ NO

Unused Orphaned Resources

Have you audited your cloud provider for unattached EBS volumes, unassigned Elastic IPs, or idle EC2 instances? Orphaned resources silently drain your startup's runway every single month.

3

☐ YES ☐ NO

CDN Caching Strategy

Are all your static assets (images, CSS, JS) and marketing pages served entirely via a global CDN like Cloudflare? Serving static assets directly from your origin server wastes bandwidth costs and slows down user experience.

4

☐ YES ☐ NO

Autoscaling Configurations

Does your application automatically scale down to zero (or a bare minimum) during off-peak hours? If you are running the same amount of servers at 3:00 AM as you are at 3:00 PM, you are paying for unused compute.

6

☐ YES ☐ NO

Monolithic vs. Microservices

Is your architecture appropriately sized for your team? Many startups prematurely adopt complex microservices (Kubernetes, Kafka) when a simple monolith would suffice, leading to massive DevOps overhead.

7

☐ YES ☐ NO

Automated Backups & DR

Do you have daily automated database backups, and have you successfully tested a restoration in the last 6 months? A backup is worthless if you haven't proven you can restore it within your RTO.

8

☐ YES ☐ NO

Log Management & Retention

Are your application logs automatically archived or deleted after 30 days? Keeping gigabytes of verbose debug logs in expensive storage solutions is a common cause of unexpected billing spikes.

9

☐ YES ☐ NO

Next-Gen Image Formats

Are your user-uploaded images automatically compressed and converted to WebP or AVIF? Serving massive PNGs or JPEGs eats up your egress bandwidth and ruins your Core Web Vitals (SEO).